INFORMATION DISSEMINATION AND CORRELATES OF THE IMPLEMENTATION OF K-12 BASIC EDUCATION PROGRAM

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ABSTRACT

The general objective of this study is to determine the information dissemination and correlates of the implementation of the k-12 basic education program in San Jose City, Philippines using descriptive design of research. The sampling design used was random sampling. Data for the study were collected using the questionnaire. Data were analyzed using measures of central tendency and statistics for social sciences. Most of the respondents' ages from 32 to 41 years old, female, married, and college graduates. They were Teacher I. They were in service for one to five years handling 34 to 84 students per class. Almost all of them were subject teachers with no advisory class and other ancillary designation handling different grade levels and subjects. Respondents handling grades VII to IX were asked to attend the division, regional, and even national level training in their specific subjects that they were handling. Communication characteristics show a negative and significant correlation with core curriculum and academic track. The following variables, involvement in developing course outline, involvement in developing instructional materials, knowledge in K-12, and adequacy of materials show positive and significant correlation with the core curriculum, academic track, TVL, and standard principles. The adequacy of facilities indicates a positive and significant relationship with the core curriculum and standard principles. The majority (55.56%) of the respondents agreed that that DepEd has conducted seminars to educate parents and students regarding the implementation of the K-12 program. These activities were done in selected schools like CPNHS (52.73%), London HS (14.53%), and Kita-Kita HS (10.91%) during PTA General Assembly. The orientation lasted for about three to four hours. It was participated by parents and teachers. The number of participants ranges from 15 to 35 to as many as 36 to 56 participants. Topics that were discussed during the orientation were the grading system (61.82%), the K-12 program (10.91%), and courses offered for senior students (9.09%). However, some schools did not conduct orientation for the implementation of the K-12 program.

Keywords: information dissemination, correlates, implementation, K-12 program

INTRODUCTION

Kindergarten and 12 years of quality basic education is a right of every Filipino, therefore they must be and will be provided by the government and will be free. Those who go through the 12 years cycle will get an elementary diploma (6 years), a junior high school diploma (4 years), and a senior high school diploma (2 years). A full 12 years of basic education will eventually be required for entry into tertiary level education (entering freshmen by SY 2018-2019 or seven years from now).

Senior High School is two years of specialized upper secondary education; students may choose a specialization based on aptitude, interests, and school capacity. The choice of career track will define the content of the subjects a student will take in Grades 11 and 12. SHS subjects fall under either the Core Curriculum or specific Tracks. There are seven Learning Areas under the Core Curriculum. These are Languages, Literature, Communication, Mathematics, Philosophy, Natural Sciences, and Social Sciences. Current content from some General Education subjects is embedded in the SHS curriculum.

Each student in Senior High School can choose among three tracks: Academic; Technical-Vocational-Livelihood; and Sports and Arts. The Academic track includes three strands: Business, Accountancy, Management (BAM); Humanities, Education, Social Sciences (HESS); and Science, Technology, Engineering, Mathematics (STEM). Students undergo immersion, which may include earn-while-you-learn opportunities, to provide them relevant exposure and experience in their chosen track.

After finishing Grade 10, a student can obtain Certificates of Competency (COC) or a National Certificate Level I (NC I). After finishing a Technical-Vocational-Livelihood track in Grade 12, a student may obtain a National Certificate Level II (NC II), provided he/she passes the competency-based assessment of the Technical Education and Skills Development Authority (TESDA). NC I and NC II improve the employability of graduates in fields like Agriculture, Electronics, and Trade.

The program implementation started last June for SY 2012–2013. Grade 1 entrants in SY 2012–2013 were the first batch to fully undergo the program, and incoming first-year high school students (or grade 7) in SY 2012–2013 were the first to undergo the junior high school curriculum. To prepare teachers for the new curriculum, a nationwide summer training program for about 140,000 grades 1 and 7 public school teachers was held in May 2012. The Department of Education (DepEd) is also working with various private school associations to cover teachers in private schools. To facilitate the transition from the existing ten-year basic education to 12 years, the DepEd will also implement the Senior High School Readiness Assessment and K to 12 Modeling.

The contribution of teachers to student learning and outcomes is widely recognized. A teacher's effectiveness has more impact on student learning than any other factor under the control of school systems, including class size, school size, and the quality of after-school programs. Every student deserves to be taught by a ready teacher. Ensuring a well-prepared teacher in every classroom, every year, is the primary responsibility of every school system in this country and the key opportunity for transforming education today. Once school systems commit to this reform endeavor, they need to assess their level of readiness— diagnosing the conditions that support or inhibit reform and mapping a path forward based on the co can shape a course of action to address gaps, build on strengths, and improve the prospects for success.

After the second year of K to12 implementation in all public schools and some private schools in the Philippines, the question of how ready are the teachers to engage in the changes in instruction and assessment still floats. Are teachers willing to embrace and accept the challenges presented during the transition of the program and the years after? Hence, this study will be conducted to generate an answer to the mentioned questions.

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

The general objective of this study is to determine the adequacy of instructional materials and facilities for the implementation of the k-12 basic education program. Specifically, the researcher would like to :

1. Characterize the profile of the respondents.
2. Describe the Manner of Information Dissemination of the K-12 Implementation to Parents and Students.
3. Determine the relationship between profile, training attended, the extent of involvement in developing course outline and Instructional materials, knowledge level, adequacy of instructional materials, and level of readiness.

REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE AND STUDIES

Kindergarten and 12 years of quality basic education is a right of every Filipino, therefore they must be and will be provided by the government and will be free. (2) Those who go through the 12 years cycle will get an elementary diploma (6 years), a junior high school diploma (4 years), and a senior high school diploma (2 years). (3) A full 12 years of basic education will eventually be required for entry into tertiary level education (entering freshmen by SY 2018-2019 or seven years from now).

Insufficient mastery of basic competencies is common due to a congested curriculum. The 12-year curriculum is being delivered in 10 years. High school graduates are younger than 18 years old and lack basic competencies and maturity. They cannot legally enter into contracts and are not emotionally mature for entrepreneurship/employment. Other countries view the 10-year education cycle as insufficient.

Nartates (2011) said that the K+12 plan will cost an estimated annual investment of P30 billion over five years. This amount will increase the Department of Education's share of the national budget from about 12 percent to 14 percent. But the Department of Education had received as much as 18 percent of the budget before. Countries considered poorer than the Philippines invest in K+12 for their children.

Rep. Raymond Palatino, a member of the Kabataan Party-list said: The new system would translate to added burden to parents who could barely send their children to school. For a poverty-stricken country such as ours, the proposal to add two years to basic education is a question of survival. This K+12 will need more allowance to implement this program. Then the parents need to work harder for them to support the studies of their children. But this program will help the students to add additional knowledge and for.

De Dios (2012) mentioned that Teachers from the Alliance of Concerned Teachers (ACT) are calling on the DepEd and the President to stop the K to 12 programs because it is not a solution to our educational system's problems. The lack of readiness to implement the K to 12 is evident with the faulty curriculum and insufficient funds to cover the basic inputs such as shortages on teachers, classrooms, textbooks, chairs, and sanitation facilities.

Umil and Viray (2012) cited that. Part of the preparations of the Department of Education (DepEd) in the implementation of the K to 12 programs is to train public school teachers. However, teachers noted that the training they have undergone was rushed and not well thought of. France Castro, secretary-general of the Alliance of Concerned Teachers (ACT) said the time spent on teachers' training is not enough. "There are lots of new things for teachers to learn to implement the new curriculum. One to two months of training is not enough. Is this what the DepEd calls as in-depth training of teachers?"

Dante A. Verdera, 49, a technical and livelihood education (TLE) and history teacher in Godofredo M. Tan Memorial School in Nueva Ecija said their training was in haste. “We underwent training for only 10 days for a subject that we will teach for one year,” Verdera told Bulatlat.com (2012).

Columnist and teacher Queena N. Lee-Chua (2012) said in her one column about the K to 12 programs, "To implement the K to 12 curricula properly, good teachers are essential." In her column titled, "Preparing Teachers for the big reform" Chua cited the June 2010 Ched (Commission on Higher Education) Zonal Research Project where tests were given to students of Bachelor of Science in Secondary Education majoring in math, biology, and English to measure their knowledge and skills. The study showed poor results. According to Chua, “The researchers said, if 75 percent is the benchmark for the minimum amount of actual learning, math majors achieved an average mean of 51.59 percent; English, 51.67 and biology, 37.86 percent.”

The 2006 survey by the National Teachers College covering students majoring in math also showed poor results. “Scores of future elementary teachers ranged from 55 to 73 percent, while their secondary counterparts scored even lower, 53 to 65 percent,” Chua said. Chua's column rooted the incompetency of teachers to the lack of academic conferences and seminar workshops, lack of resources such as availability of instructional materials, most specially updated references, among others. The same also goes for the training of teachers and the hasty implementation of the new curriculum for the school year 2012-2013.

Castor (2012) found that the main source of information regarding the new curriculum was a seminar. The teachers have undergone series of training and seminars. Information from the said seminars was handled down to parents through orientation to help them understand the benefits they could get from the said curriculum transformation. The same with the process that teachers have undergone with the K-12 seminars, parents were grouped and scheduled to attend this orientation. These were conducted at different venues and times to reach the parents and the community as well.

Based on the result of Castor's (2012) study, teachers stated that knowledgeable enough in terms of the objectives of the K-12 program. Specifically, they stated that they were aware that the K-12 program provides sufficient time for mastery of concepts and skills to develop learners as well as prepare the learners for tertiary education, middle-level skills development, employment, and entrepreneurship. Results revealed that respondents admitted that they were highly knowledgeable in the use of the mother-tongue as the medium of instruction from grades 1 to 3. Moreover, respondents also admitted that they were knowledgeable in terms of using English and Filipino as a medium of instruction starting from grades 4 to 6.

In terms of the teacher: students ratio, results revealed that more than half of the teacher-respondents handled a class with several students ranging from 32 to 53 pupils. The remaining percent stated that they were teaching students with a class size ranging from 9 to 31 students. The majority of the respondents stated that there was a teacher: classroom ratio of one is to one.

With the result of the study, more than half of the respondents stated that their class has a 1:1 ratio between books and pupils. Others have stated that 2 to 3 pupils were sharing in one book. Alarmingly, responses revealed that 15.15% of the respondents admitted that they have no textbooks for pupils. According to the responses of the teachers (68.18%), there was a 1:1 ratio of chairs to pupils/students in their class. Some (24.24%) have stated that there were 1:2 ratios between chair and pupil. Others (7.58%) said that 3 pupils were sharing in one chair.

After the seminar of the teachers in the K-12 program, the DepEd have given them PELC, Lesson Plans, Reference Books, and Manuals that they could use in the implementation of the program. However, these materials given were not enough, hence, responses were moderately adequate except for manuals having a qualitative interpretation of adequate. Facilities such as a library, comfort rooms, teachers' working area, and reading rooms for moderately adequate as these facilities were all present in almost all of the schools even the K-12 program was not implemented. Classrooms and chairs were said to be adequate for the pupils/students.

Hartsock, (2001) Teachers in the elementary education program are well prepared in their content areas and with the most recent research-based knowledge of instruction and curriculum. They learn to improve schooling in a democratic society and build a more just, sustainable world. They strive to help all students develop conceptual understandings and fluency, become active citizens, and make significant contributions to society. We prepare our teachers to be self-critical, lifelong learners who have a strong sense of agency and who will become tomorrow's educational leaders.

Mckensie (2012) mentioned that not only should teachers exhibit the skills necessary for communicating ideas clearly to students, but they must also communicate with parents, other teachers, their administrators, and their communities.

Wolfe and Haveman (2002), economists noted for their efforts to put a monetary value on some of education's spillover effects, argue that the value of these spillovers for individuals and the economy is significant and that it may be as large as education market-based individual benefits. Improving the quality of a state's public K–12 education can result in greater economic development through both of these channels.

Hungerford (2004) stated that from the literature review he conducted if faced with the choice of (1) increasing revenue state-wide to continue supporting the provision of quality public–12 education or (2) cutting support state-wide to public K–12 education to forestall a tax increase, a state's long-term economic interests are better served by increasing revenue. He reached this conclusion by examining the evidence on the large spillover benefits of a quality public education beyond the direct benefit to those who receive it, the direct data-based evidence of the influence that various taxes and fees and K–12 education expenditures have on economic development, and the empirical evidence on how a quality public education influences the K–12 Education in the U.S. Economy individual's lifetime earnings and the value of homes in the school district where it is provided.

METHODOLOGY

In this study, a descriptive survey method was used to know the teachers' readiness in teaching the K to 12 curricula. Respondents were selected using random sampling from San Jose City, Philippines secondary schools these are Constancio Padilla National High School, Caanawan High School, and Sto. Nino 3rd National High School, KKHS, Tondod High School, and Pinili High School. Data for the study were collected using the questionnaire.

RESULTS AND DISCUSSIONS

Profile of the Respondents

Most of the respondents' age ranges from 32 to 41 years old and 42 to 51 years old having a percent of 33.33 % and 31.31% respectively. Others were younger (27.27%) aging from 22 to 31 years old. The majority (71.7%) of the respondents are female and the remaining percent are male.

More than 70% of the respondents were married and others were single and widow having percent of 27.3% and 2.0% respectively. The majority (79.8%) of the respondents were college graduates. Only 12.1% of them were able to graduate with their Masteral degree. Others have only earned units in their post-graduate program. More than half (50.5%) of the respondents were Teacher I during the conduct of the study. Forty-five and five-tenths percent of them were Teacher III. Some were Teacher II (2.0%) and Master Teacher (2.0%). More than 30% of the respondents were in the service for only one to five years. Some (26.26%) were teaching for six to ten (10) years. Others have been in the teaching profession from 11-15 and 16-20 years having the same percent respectively. The mean 11.79 and standard deviation of 88.72 indicate that respondents were relatively new in the service and that their years in service have great differences from each other. Only 18.2% of the respondents were teaching Filipino. Some were teaching English and ESP having the same percent of 13.1% respectively. Some were handling AP (11.1%) and Science (10.1%). As seen on the table, respondents (75.76%) were handling 34-84 students per class. Some (11.11%) were handling 187-237 students per class. The mean of 85.42 students per class signifies that respondents' classes were congested and the standard deviation of 75.53 indicates that students' number per class were widely diverse from each class. Most (35.4%) of the respondents were handling grade VIII. Others were teaching grade IX and VII having a percent of 24.2% and 26.3% respectively. The remaining (14.1%) were handling grade X.

Table 1. Profile the Respondents

Age	Frequency	Percent
62 and above	1	1.01
52-61	7	7.07
42-51	31	31.31
32-41	33	33.33
22-31	27	27.27
Total	99	100
Mean:38.44		
SD:10.19		
Range:22-62		
Gender		
Male	28	28.3
Female	71	71.7
Total	99	100.0
Civil Status		
Single	27	27.3
Married	70	70.7
Widow	2	2.0

Total	99	100.0
Educational Attainment		
College Graduate	79	79.8
With MA units	8	8.1
MA Graduate	12	12.1
Total	99	100.0
Position		
Teacher I	50	50.5
Teacher II	2	2.0
Teacher III	45	45.5
Master Teacher	2	2.0
Total	99	100.0
Years		
31-35	2	2.02
26-30	8	8.08
21-25	9	9.09
16-20	12	12.12
11-15	12	12.12
6-10	26	26.26
1-5	30	30.30
Total	99	100.00
Mean:11.79		
SD:8>72		
Range:1-34		
Subjects		
Filipin o	18	18.2
English	13	13.1
Science	10	10.1
Values	3	3.0
ESP	13	13.1
Math	13	13.1
A.P	11	11.1
TLE	10	10.1
Mape	8	8.1
Total	99	100.0
Number		
289-339	2	2.02
238-288	5	5.05
187-237	11	11.11
136-186	3	3.03
85-135	3	3.03
34-84	75	75.76
Total	99	100
Mean:85.42		

SD:75.53 Range:34-300		
Grade Level		
7.00	26	26.3
8.00	35	35.4
9.00	24	24.2
10.00	14	14.1
Total	99	100.0

Designation Other than Teaching

Beyond the subjects handled by the respondents, some of them were handling other auxiliary designation. Only 10.10% of them were assigned as advisers of classes. Some were assigned as subject area chairpersons. A significant percent (64.65%) of them have no assignments aside from teaching the subjects that they were handling.

Table 2. Designation Other than Teaching

Designation other than teaching	Frequency	Percentage
None	64	64.65
Adviser	10	10.10
Librarian	2	2.02
Coordinator	7	7.07
Liaison	1	1.01
In charge TLE cottage	1	1.01
Area chair	7	7.07
Guidance facilitator	3	3.03
Treasurer	1	1.01
Encoder	1	1.01
Records officer	1	1.01
SPED teacher	1	1.01
Total	99	100

Training attended on K – 12 Implementation

Before the implementation of the K-12 programs, teachers were required to attend seminars and training to equip them with the necessary skills to implement the program. Respondents handling grades VII to IX were asked to attend the division, regional, and even national level training in their specific subjects that they were handling. The following table shows the list of training attended by the respondents:

Table 3. Training attended on K – 12 Implementation

*Title	Frequency	Rank
Mass training Grade of 9 Filipino teachers	12	2
Fifth National Congress in the Filipino Language	1	16
Regional mass training for English teachers	4	7.5
Mass training for Grade 8 teachers	7	3.5
K – 12 mass training	14	1
None	3	10.5
K – 12 grade 7	7	3.5
Regional mass training for math teachers	5	6
Grade 9 mathematics	1	16
Grade 9 Science	3	10.5
K – 12 AP	6	5
K – 12 ESP	3	10.5
CHS Tesda	3	10.5
Grade 8 science seminar	1	
National training for teachers	1	16
INSET K – 12	1	16

**Multiple responses* **None - 29*

Manner of Information Dissemination of the K-12 Implementation to Parents and Students

Since the K-12 program was new to the academe, DepEd finds it necessary to conduct activities to educate parents and students. The following table was the manner of information dissemination done with regards to the implementation of the K-12 program.

The majority (55.56%) of the respondents agreed that that DepEd has conducted seminars to educate parents and students regarding the implementation of the K-12 program. These activities were done in selected schools like CPNHS (52.73%), London HS (14.53%), and Kita-Kita HS (10.91%) during PTA General Assembly. The orientation lasted for about three to four hours. It was participated by parents and teachers. Several participants range from 15 to 35 to as many as 36 to 56 participants.

Topics that were discussed during the orientation were the grading system (61.82%), the K-12 program (10.91%), and courses offered for senior students (9.09%).

However, some schools did not conduct orientation for the implementation of the K-12 program. The following reasons were ranked based on the frequency of the responses: ranked one was the reason that there was no plan for the school to conduct the said orientation; the second was school was waiting for the principal to schedule the program; third was the reason that orientation was already done by the EPS Division Officers/Principals.

Table 4. Manner of Information Dissemination of the K-12Implementation to Parents and Students

Items	Frequency	Percent
Conducted orientation to parents and students regarding K-12		
Yes	55	55.56
No	44	44.44
Total	**99**	100.00
Place where the orientation conducted (for yes answer)		
London high school	8	14.55
Kita Kita H.S	6	10.91
CPNHS	29	52.73
PHS	3	5.45
Sto Nino 3rd HS	4	7.27
Canavan high school	5	9.09
Total	**55**	**100**
5hrs	2	3.64
3hrs	12	21.82
2hrs	9	16.36
4hrs	10	18.18
24hrs	1	1.82
12hrs	3	5.45
Total	**55**	**100**
Participants during orientation		
Students	15	27.27
Parents	36	65.45
Teachers	4	7.27
Number of Participants	**55**	**100**
99 and above	2	3.64
78-98	10	18.18
57-77	8	14.55
36-56	16	29.09
15-35	19	34.55
	55	**100.00**
Topics Discussed		
K – 12 Senior high school	5	9.09
Advantages of K – 12 curriculum number of years in the high school	4	7.27
Courses to offer for the senior high school	5	9.09
Grading system	34	61.82
Junior/Elementary high school	1	1.82
About K – 12	6	10.91
Reasons for not conducting orientations	**55**	100
		Rank
None	87	1

Waiting for the schedule from the office of the principal	5	2
No chance of having a resource speaker	2	4.5
Don't have an advisory class	1	6.5
Not attended	2	4.5
Orientation was already done by ESP division officer/principal	4	3
Better to conduct orientation in a group	1	6.5

Correlations between profile, training attended, the extent of involvement in developing course outline, Instructional materials, knowledge level, adequacy of instructional materials, level of readiness and core curriculum, academic track, TVL, and standard principles,

In looking at the correlation of the profiles of the respondents to the core curriculum, academic track, TVL, and standard principles, the result shows that none of it was correlated with each other. Training attended the show a negative and significant correlation with core curriculum and academic track.

The variables involved in developing course outline, involvement in developing instructional materials, knowledge in K-12, and adequacy of materials show positive and significant correlation with the core curriculum, academic track, TVL, and standard principles. These signify that the more they were involved in the development of course outline and instructional materials; knowledge in the principles of the program and instructional materials were adequate the better they were in the execution of the K-12 program.

The adequacy of facilities indicates a positive and significant relationship with the core curriculum and standard principles. This means that if facilities were adequate, respondents tend to do better in teaching the subjects in the core curriculum and the better they were in applying the standard principles in teaching the K-12 program.

Table 5. Correlations between profile, training attended, the extent of involvement in developing course outline, Instructional materials, knowledge level, adequacy of instructional materials, level of readiness and core curriculum, academic track, TVL, and standard principles,

	Core curriculum	Academic track	Technical vocational-Livelihood track	Standard principles
Profile	.070	.028	.061	-.003
Training attended	-.325(**)	-.226(*)	-.095	-.094
Involvement in developing a course outline	.270(**)	.246(**)	.200(**)	.145(**)

Involvement in developing instructional materials	.427(**)	.205(**)	.148(*)	.157(**)
Knowledge on K to 12	.224(**)	.317(**)	.231(**)	.405(**)
Adequacy of instructional materials	.175(**)	.248(**)	.182(**)	.421(**)
Adequacy of facilities	.103(**)	.063	.009	.186(**)

** Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).
* Correlation is significant at the 0.05 level (2-tailed).

CONCLUSIONS

Regarding the manner of information, parents were educated on the objectives, course offering, grading system, and the cycle of the K-12 program thru the orientation done by the schools during the PTA General Assembly.

Correlation between the profile, training attended, involvement in the preparation of course outline and instructional materials, knowledge on K-12 program, and adequacy of instructional materials and facilities and core curriculum, academic track, TVL track, and standard principles established a significant relationship with each other.

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Follow-up training for teachers should be conducted to make them more confident in teaching the K12 curriculum.

2.Consider the influence of different variables that shows significant correlations in conducting capability development for teachers.

3. Research and evaluation should be done to assess the effectiveness of the program in developing our learners.

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